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HRRP BULLETIN

12 November 2018



[How do Baliyo Ghar mobile teams work? \(video\)](#): this 5 minute video shows how mobile teams (each team has an Engineer, Social Development Officer, and Construction Technician) under NSET's reconstruction programme 'Baliyo Ghar' work in earthquake affected areas.

Highlights

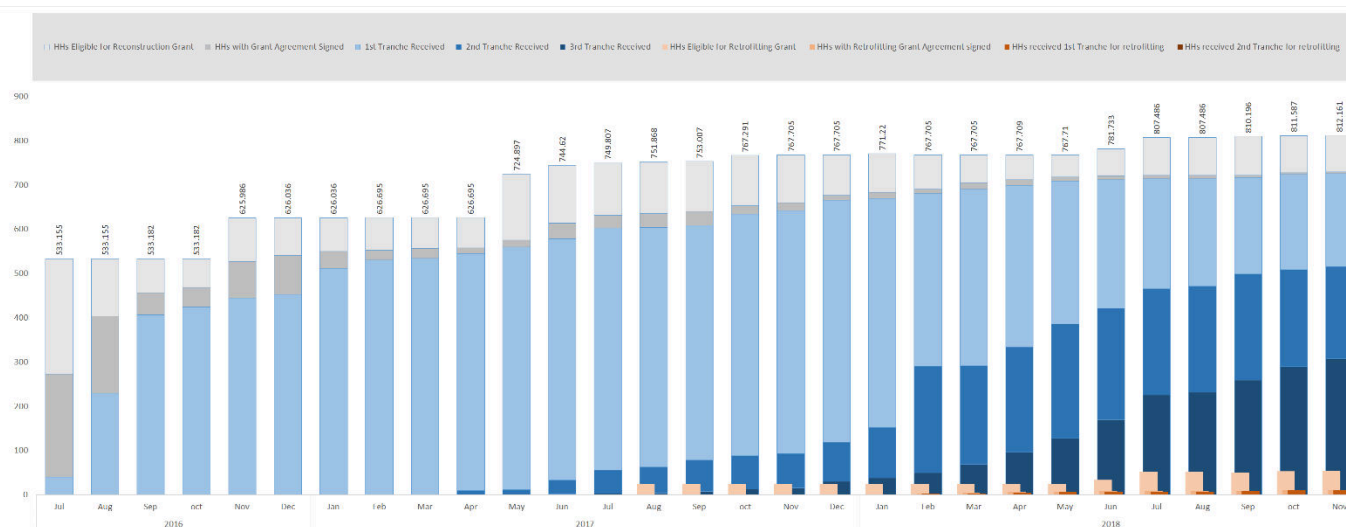
- The number of households that have received the third tranche of the housing reconstruction grant is now more than 300,000!
- [Report](#) on third round of the HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey – huge thanks to all the respondents who took the time to share feedback and help to improve the platform.
- Update from Hollow Concrete Block (HCB) Technical Working Group (TWG)
- Nepal representation at UK Shelter Forum on 23 November
- HRRP Recovery Advisor, Siobhan Kennedy, awarded 'International Engineer of the Year 2018' by Engineers Ireland, professional body for engineering sector in Ireland.
- During the HRRP district coordination meeting in Dhading on 31 October it was highlighted that Partner Organisation (PO) reconstruction activities are now limited or have been completed. As a result, households require more technical support from Government technical staff but there are issues with the availability of the technical staff in the field. A [survey with government technical staff](#) carried out earlier this year shows that the technical staff are working in challenging circumstances and require additional support if they are to be able to carry out their work effectively.
- During the HRRP district coordination meeting in Nuwakot on 31 October, the [Common Feedback Project](#) (CFP) shared findings from research conducted in four Rural Municipalities in the district. The research found that 55% of houses constructed are two room houses, 20% are four room houses, 13% are one room houses, 7% have more than four rooms, and 5% are three room houses. The CBS damage assessment data shows that just 11% of houses were 33m² or less pre-earthquake, where the CFP data shows that this is now the case for 68% of houses in the research area.

UPDATES & REQUESTS

National

[NRA, CLPIU GMALI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 12 November:](#)

Reconstruction Grant	15 October	29 October	12 November
Total No. Eligible HHs	811,857	811,857	812,161
HHs Enrolled	727,237	727,875	730,073
HHs Received 1 st Tranche	723,396	724,253	725,373
HHs Applied for 2 nd Tranche	528,107	528,561	530,440
HHs Received 2 nd Tranche	509,066	510,253	515,758
HHs Applied for 3 rd Tranche	332,540	335,704	342,254
HHs Received 3 rd Tranche	289,862	293,044	306,924
Retrofit Grant	15 October	29 October	12 November
Total No. Eligible HHs	53,318	53,318	54,658
HHs Enrolled	10,778	10,877	11,475
HHs Received 1 st Tranche	9,640	9,748	9,873
HHs Received 2 nd Tranche	359	359	359



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMALI CLPIU, and Building CLPIU data from July 2016 to 12 November 2018.

NRA Meeting on ‘Strategy for Training and Orientation on Housing Reconstruction’, 5 November: the meeting, chaired by NRA CEO, Sushil Gyewali, focused on planning for proposed orientations at central and district levels across all 32 earthquake affected districts. The orientations have the following objectives:

- To fulfill the need for an adequate information dissemination framework from national to local level and vice versa.
- To strengthen communication and coordination between municipalities and government Institutions
- To disseminate information regarding revisions to the technical and administrative guidelines and manuals formulated by the National Reconstruction Authority.
- To develop instructors at various levels and an appropriate training and orientation framework.

The first phase of orientations will cover the 14 most affected districts and the second phase will cover the 18 moderately affected districts. The target participants in the orientation programs are the Chiefs and focal persons

of DLPIUs, District Support Engineers and the local elected representatives of the municipalities and rural municipalities of all the 31 earthquake affected districts. The orientations will also provide necessary information to the major stakeholders to be disseminated further at the local levels; to the ward chairpersons and members and community people. In this way, the orientation aims to cascade the information at the national level to the community level, thus providing much needed boost for expediting the housing reconstruction progress.

Update on Hollow Concrete Block Technical Working Group (TWG) Progress: the group is working towards producing a manual on Hollow Concrete Block (HCB) construction under the GoN housing reconstruction programme. The group has already completed a field visit to identify non-compliances and problems in existing construction and the drafting of inspection forms. Laboratory testing in the Institute of Engineering, as well as numerical modelling are ongoing. The group has started working on drafting guidelines for producers of HCBs and the drafting of the manual is also underway. Anyone interested to support, or requiring additional information on the TWGs work, is requested to contact Kuber Bogati, HRRP National Technical Coordination Officer, techofficer1.national@hrrpnepal.org.

Workshop on HRRP and Building CLPIU Joint Monitoring Field Visits, 5 November: a review and planning workshop for Joint Monitoring (JM) Field Visits was organised jointly by HRRP and NRA/CLPIU Building/M&E at the DUDBC hall. The joint field visits are being conducted by Building CLPIU and HRRP in the 14 most affected districts and have been taking place regularly since February 2018. The main objectives of the workshop were to assess the impact of the field visits carried out to date and to plan the field visits that will be carried out in the next 6 months. A draft guideline for joint monitoring field visits was also presented in the workshop to ensure a common approach is maintained for all visits. The Building CLPIU Project Director, Mr. Nava Raj Pyakurel, and Deputy Project Director, Mr. Japad Bishwakarma, addressed the workshop.

Engineers Ireland 'International Engineer of the Year' 2018: Engineers Ireland, the professional body for the engineering sector in Ireland, held their annual 'Excellence Awards' on Friday, 9 November. At the event, Siobhan Kennedy, HRRP Recovery Advisor, won the 'International Engineer of the Year' award.



Left: 'International Engineers of the Year' award section from 'Excellence Awards' booklet. Right: Siobhan after receiving the award, pictured with (from left to right) Caroline Spillane, Engineers Ireland Director General, Margeurite Sayers, Executive Director Customer Solutions for ESB Group and Vice President of Engineers Ireland, and Peter Quinn, President of Engineers Ireland.

Districts & Municipalities

Training of Trainers (ToT) on Earthquake Resistant Shelter Construction for Engineers, Sub-engineers and Assistant Sub-engineers, 28 October-3 November, Manthali, Ramechhap: the training was organised by NRCS, in collaboration with Building CLPIU, for technical staff working in four districts; Ramechhap, Sindhuli, Okhaldunga, and Solukhumbu. The training was provided to engineers who has been newly deployed to the districts. In total 80 technical staff completed the training. Trainers were provided by NRCS, Building CLPIU, NRA (DSE), DUDBC, and HRRP. Congratulations to all involved!



The closing ceremony of the training.

Purna Bahadur Gurung – a reconstruction leader in Dhading: Purna Bahadur Gurung, 51, lives in Kafal Chaap of Khalte, ward No. 1, Nilkantha Municipality, Dhading. When he was young, he worked as a labourer in Kathmandu for some years but became frustrated and returned to his village to work with his father who was a mason. For 22 years Purna worked on construction of houses in his village. But then the 2015 Gorkha Earthquake destroyed his house, and 20 other houses in his village, and Purna felt that his knowledge and skills were not sufficient to support safer reconstruction. During this period Purna had the opportunity to take part in a mason training course for existing masons that was delivered by the NSET Baliyo Ghar programme. After the training, Purna felt confident with the technical concepts and knowledge required to reconstruct earthquake resistant houses and was able to make his village resilient to future earthquake and bring new masons on board to work with him. The impact of this is felt in many ways, with the village rebuilt quicker than in many other areas and increased employment opportunities reducing the number of people migrating for work. "I have 2 ex-drivers working with me. Earlier they used to earn Rs. 15 thousand per month but now they are making Rs. 30 thousand, it's quite pleasing" says Purna. The masons worked following the Parma System, a system of exchanging labours to expedite the reconstruction works in the village. Tika Budhathoki, Social Development Officer with NSET-Baliyo Ghar informed, "under the leadership of Mr. Purna Bahadur Gurung, the village is now resilient. We have witnessed that a trained mason in a small village has a great value". Purna is now planning to travel to other villages to support people in other areas to rebuild safely and cost effectively.



Left: Purna Bahadur Gurung. Right: the village of Kafal Chaap which is now resilient to future earthquakes.

HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 26 Oct – 8 Nov: during this period district coordination meetings took place in Sindhupalchok (30 October), Dhading (31 October), Kathmandu (31 October), Nuwakot (31 October), and Dolakha (1 November). Municipal level meetings took place in Panchakanya Rural Municipality, Nuwakot (30 October), Siddhicharan Municipality, Okhaldhunga (31 October), Jiri Municipality, Dolakha (31 October), and Ghanglekh Rural Municipality, Sindhuli (1 November). Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- In **Sindhupalchok**, GMALI shared that in Panchpokhari Thangpal Rural Municipality 330 out of 351 households added through the grievance process have received the first tranche but 21 have not been in contact. In Helambu, 500 households have not started reconstruction; some have houses in another place, some are unable to start due to poor financial status, and some are unwilling to start reconstruction. It was suggested that households think the Government will again extend the tranche disbursement deadline so they do not feel under pressure to meet it. Due to the shortage of completion certificates there has been delay in distribution of completion certificates in Helambu. GMALI suggested that the field Engineers should collect the completion certificates that are available at the Building DLPIU. The initial project analysis of integrated settlements will be supported by Building DLPIU in close coordination with the field technical staff. A follow up will be done with the displaced households that have taken the second tranche.
- In **Dhading**, Partner Organisation (PO) reconstruction activities are now limited or have been completed. As a result, households require more technical support from Government technical staff but there are issues with the availability of the technical staff in the field. There not enough skilled and unskilled masons to meet demand, and there is a lack of people between 18 – 40 years old that are interested to take part in mason training.
- In **Kathmandu**, the meeting was conducted with the focal persons from 11 municipalities in Kathmandu District as well as some of the Building DLPIU engineers. Participants discussed the main reconstruction issues and challenges they have faced including, land issues such as lack of ownership papers or multiple owners. The participants felt that the land issues had created a reluctance among home owners to reconstruct their houses under the Government reconstruction programme. There is a good supply of construction materials in all parts of Kathmandu district but land issues and challenges with access to finance are making it difficult for some households to reconstruct. There are also non-compliant houses that were built soon after the earthquake without following bylaws and minimum requirements and require corrections to be carried out if the household is to receive subsequent tranches of the government housing reconstruction grant.
- In **Nuwakot**, UNRCO/CFP shared the findings from the research conducted in four Rural Municipalities: Belkotgadhi, Dupcheshor, Tadi and Panchakanya where it was reported that 55% of houses constructed are two room houses, 20% are four room houses, 13% are one room houses, 7% have more than four rooms, and 5% are three room houses. It was also reported that households mostly depend on government technical staff as their source of information on reconstruction.
- In **Dolakha**, UNDP has launched a new programme, 3R-Resilient Reconstruction & Recovery, in the same working areas as previous programmes. IOM shared that their new programme, People to People, will launch in November. The DUDBC chief officially announced his transfer to the central office and shared that he had a wonderful time working in Dolakha.
- In, **Panchakanya RM, Nuwakot**, delays in addressing grievances, non-compliances, and land issues were discussed. There is a gap between second and third tranche disbursement because many households rushed construction to DPC level to meet the NRA second tranche disbursement deadline but are now working to their own schedule for the remaining works. However, there are some wards where there has been good progress on disbursement of the third tranche. Where households have not taken the first tranche it is mostly because they are living abroad or do not have land. There is increased construction of one room houses in the area, especially built by those living in Kathmandu.
- In **Siddhicharan Municipality, Okhaldhunga**, issues related to non-compliant houses built immediately after the earthquake were discussed. Most houses have been rebuilt as two storey stone and mud mortar

masonry houses with no vertical reinforcement and horizontal bands. The Ward Chairperson requested NRA to provide clear guidelines on how to address these cases so that households can receive the remaining tranches.

- In **Jiri Municipality, Dolakha**, 18 families that have completed their houses have not received the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. It was reported that there are houses that have been listed as eligible for the GoN retrofit grant that are not suitable for retrofitting. There have been delays in tranche disbursement by the banks, even when the money has been deposited with the banks for disbursement. As the reconstruction work in the district is almost completed trained masons have started to migrate to other places in search of other jobs. A ward office has allowed local people to use materials from Khimti river free of cost for the construction of houses and provided timber from the community forest for doors and windows.
- In **Ghyanglekh RM, Sindhuli**, lack of monitoring of trained masons, insufficient Door to Door technical assistance, lengthy tranche process, unavailability of technical persons at Rural Municipalities, and challenges in transportation of construction materials in rural areas were discussed. Due to lack of information on reconstruction at municipal level, all Ward offices were requested to submit monthly report to the municipality. It was agreed that at least one meeting at ward level with the DLPIU Engineers will be held each month. It was decided at municipal level to start an awareness programme in all wards to speed up reconstruction. A need for a Coordination Engineer was discussed to coordinate reconstruction activities among wards, municipalities, Building DLPIU, and GMALI DLPIU.

HRRP District Coordination Team Gorkha, Weekly District Report, 26 Oct – 8 Nov 2018



Ward No. 9, Siranchowk Rural Municipality, Gorkha: brick and cement mortar masonry house with RCC bands. The home owner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok, Weekly District Report, 26 Oct – 8 Nov 2018



Ward No. 9, Mandan Deupur Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: brick and cement mortar masonry house. The home owner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant. The total cost of construction was 800,000 NPRs.

HRRP District Coordination Team Nuwakot, Weekly District Report, 26 Oct – 8 Nov 2018



Ward No. 3, Panchakanya Rural Municipality, Nuwakot: stone and mud mortar masonry house. The home owner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Okhaldhunga, Weekly District Report, 26 Oct – 8 Nov 2018



Ward No. 6, Siddhicharan Municipality, Okhaldhunga: a three room, stone and mud mortar masonry house with RCC bands and flexible roof. The home owner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhuli, Weekly District Report, 26 Oct – 8 Nov 2018



Ward No. 2, Ghanglekh Rural Municipality, Sindhuli: a load bearing brick and cement mortar masonry house. The home owner has received the second tranche of the Government housing reconstruction grant. The total cost of construction of the house was 900,000 NPRs due to high transportation cost of construction materials.

Requests for Partner Support

Support for Timber Training Sindhuli: timber structures are the most prevalent building typology in this area and there is a high demand for technical training on the timber manual. As a result, HRRP is working to plan and facilitate these in Sindhuli district but support is needed from Partner Organisations. If your organisation can support, please contact Bhubaneswori Parajuli, HRRP National Technical Coordination, techcord.national@hrrpnepal.org.

Urban Reconstruction: the NRA will be issuing a letter to Partner Organisations (POs) soon to invite them to take part in an informal discussion on urban reconstruction which will take place at the end of this week or the end of next week. HRRP has been working with NRA and others to establish a Technical Working Group (TWG) focused on urban reconstruction and it is expected that this will follow from the upcoming NRA meeting. Anyone interested to participate is requested to contact Bhubaneswori Parajuli, HRRP National Technical Coordination, techcord.national@hrrpnepal.org.

UK Shelter Forum, 23 November 2018: the forum will be hosted by Arup and ShelterBox on 23 November 2018, in London. There will be two sessions focused on the Nepal response. One is a plenary session that will include a video presentation from Sushil Gyewali, NRA CEO. The other is a breakout session looking at 'ensuring continuity of the recovery process at the local level' which will be jointly delivered by NSET, HRRP, and Open University. If you have any questions or would like to contribute to the content for the Nepal sessions please contact HRRP Recovery Advisor, Siobhan Kennedy, siobhan@hrrpnepal.org. All documents from the previous UK Shelter Forum meeting in June 2018 are available [here](#).

DOCUMENTS & PRODUCTS

HRRP

Report on 3rd round of HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey: many thanks to the 230 people who took the time to respond. Some interesting findings include:

- 37% of respondents reported using HRRP maps to select working areas
- 62% of respondents reported they / their organisation had made changes to activities or programme(s) based on information shared or discussed at HRRP district level events and 51% reported making changes to activities or programmes based on information shared or discussed at HRRP municipal level events
- 72% of respondents suggested that HRRP should conduct workshops at provincial level
- Several respondents suggested that if HRRP is continued the platform should have more focus on urban reconstruction and on supporting reconstruction in the 18 moderately affected districts

HRRP is working on an action plan based on the results of the survey and will implement improvements as appropriate over the coming months.

Partners

ASF Nepal Newsletter, Issue No. 22, September 2018: this issue provides updates on ASF Nepal's work in Kavre under their Nepal Earthquake Assistance Programme (NEAP), in partnership with Habitat for Humanity Nepal. This includes Housing Support Services Centres (HSSCs), PASSA sessions, and technical supervision of construction. The newsletter also includes an update on ASF Nepal's work in Bungamati.